

Nice to meet you

*this is the name of the proposal, although we're sure it will also be nice to actually meet you in person

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Overview

Multimedia installation consisting of 88 flat stones placed one after another to form a path. The stone road can be walked on, in fact the desired outcome is for people to naturally and instinctively step on it. When that happens, the installation comes to life. Until the people came in contact with it, it was just a stone road, but now they are controlling the artwork.

What does it do exactly?

Each stone represents one family, one business, one member of the local community. When you search Sant Jordi Desvalls on Wikipedia, it says the town has a population of 880 residents, so 88 stones would be a reference to that (88 is the desired outcome but since it might become a very long installation, the number might need to be adjusted depending on how much space it will take). When a stone is stepped on, a sound emerges, the sound of a resident's greeting. Each person with their own manner of welcoming someone, each one different, each one representative of the people of Sant Jordi Desvalls. As people walk on the stones, they discover the voices of the community that surrounds them.

How does it work?

- Motion/pressure/proximity sensors attached to the stones that start the recordings
- Speakers mounted on the walls besides the stone road or nearby it
- Recordings of the residents greeting us

How will we do it?

As part of the residency, we will take on our duty to the community and involve them in this artwork from day 1, by getting to know them and recording their first impression of meeting us. We will knock on doors, learn Catalan phrases and try to build connections with people. As part of the artwork, the first noise, word or phrase that we will be greeted with we will record and use in the installation. In this way. We will hopefully summarize into an artwork the warm, polite, friendly and welcoming nature of this town and what makes it whole, its people.

That's it.

We want to make something that blends in the scene, an artwork that isn't flashy, but one that rather surprises people and invites them to play and discover. Our goal would be to create something that gives people a moment of joy and maybe make them realise how the community that they are building is seen (or heard) from a non-local's perspective.